

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Hospitality and Tourism English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

02 Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

03 Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

04 Revenue Management and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

05 Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

06 Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Clarify missing information before responding.

07 Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

08 Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Clarify missing information before responding.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

CASE

A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Teach this move

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Vocabulary to check: check-in, room inventory, upgrade, service recovery.

Model response

I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Second-round challenge

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Language-check answers

1. C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear. This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.
2. B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status. A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

05 • Conversations

1. Arrival confirmed, room not ready - Fictional hotel training: a corporate travel coordinator arrives with a guest group before rooms are ready; luggage storage is available, but readiness is unverified.
2. The breakfast inclusion correction - Separate fictional case: a reservation lists room only, but an agent's welcome message incorrectly says breakfast included; a corporate booking manager calls.

3. A quiet-room request is not a guarantee - Separate fictional case: a tour leader's arrival sheet incorrectly calls a quiet-room request guaranteed; no alternative room has been verified.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An arrival entrance changes

In a fictional hotel, a conference group's confirmation names the main entrance, but its booked reception desk is at the garden entrance. Both entrances are open; luggage assistance has not been confirmed. Correct the message by phone before arrival.

Role A: Front desk supervisor: acknowledge the incorrect entrance instruction and explain the verified reception location.

Role B: Conference coordinator: explain that delegates have the old instruction and ask about luggage assistance.

Possible opening: Our confirmation named the wrong reception entrance, and I want to correct that before your group arrives.

Success checks

- Take responsibility for the incorrect message.
- Distinguish the confirmed entrance from unconfirmed assistance.
- Agree how the coordinator will pass on the correction.

Add a complication: The coordinator asks you to guarantee that a porter will meet the coach, but availability is unknown.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Describe observed behavior, its effect, and a useful next step.

CASE

A draft response to an online review argues with the guest and includes booking details. The team needs a courteous public reply.

Teach this move

Use a specific example instead of a personality label. Explain its effect, invite the person's perspective, and agree on a practical improvement. Focus on communication that can be changed, not accent or national identity.

Vocabulary to check: guest complaint, online review, brand voice, compensation.

Model response

Thank you for sharing your experience. We're sorry the visit did not meet expectations. Please contact our service team through the private channel so we can review the details with you.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision identifies observable work. 'Always' and a personality judgment make the feedback harder to verify or act on.

Second-round challenge

The recipient disagrees with your interpretation. Return to the observed example, listen, and revise an unsupported assumption.

Language-check answers

1. B - The last two updates omitted the agreed completion date. The recipient can check the specific examples and discuss how to improve them.
2. A - What is making this part of the task difficult? An open question may reveal a barrier the speaker has not considered.

05 • Conversations

1. Remove the booking details from the reply - Fictional review meeting: a draft public response quotes a guest's booking reference and disputes the complaint; nothing has been posted.

2. The apology that ignored the noise - Separate fictional case: a hotel response thanks a reviewer for praising breakfast but ignores their detailed noise complaint.

3. Feedback on an interrupted complaint call - Separate fictional coaching case: a supervisor and reservations agent review a training call in which the agent interrupts a conference organizer twice.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A reply sounds copied

A fictional hotel's response to a complaint about a missed wake-up call thanks the guest for their restaurant feedback. The response is still a draft. Hold a coaching conversation and agree one check before posting.

Role A: Guest relations supervisor: identify the exact mismatch and its likely effect without criticizing personality.

Role B: Trainee: explain that you reused a draft and ask how to check relevance efficiently.

Possible opening: This draft refers to restaurant feedback, but the guest complained about a missed wake-up call.

Success checks

- Describe the observed mismatch rather than labeling the trainee.
- Invite the trainee's perspective.
- Agree a specific check that preserves a courteous brand voice.

Add a complication: The trainee says using a template is necessary during busy periods.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

CASE

A booking issue means the reserved room type is unavailable. Staff have two alternatives within their approved service process.

Teach this move

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

Vocabulary to check: overbooking, walk, occupancy, rate parity.

Model response

The reserved room type is unavailable, and I'm sorry for the inconvenience. Let me explain the two available options, including any differences in facilities or cost, so you can choose what works for you.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Second-round challenge

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Language-check answers

1. A - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule. The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.
2. C - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope. This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

05 · Conversations

1. Twin rooms or a partner property - Fictional overbooking case: a hotel authorizes either two twin rooms onsite or two doubles at a partner property for one night at the booked total; transport is not yet arranged.
2. Keeping a three-night stay together - Separate fictional case: a group can book six standard rooms for three nights or six superior rooms for two nights followed by a move to standard rooms; quoted totals are equal.

3. Comparing channel offers fairly - Separate fictional reservation case: a direct offer includes breakfast and flexible cancellation; an agency offer is room only with different cancellation terms. No matched rate has been authorized.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | One room category for a later arrival

A fictional retreat can reserve four identical rooms starting Wednesday, or two standard and two superior rooms starting Tuesday. The retreat organizer prefers Tuesday and identical rooms. No further inventory is confirmed. Negotiate a proposal for organizer approval.

Role A: Reservations coordinator: offer the two verified allocations and make the date or room-category tradeoff explicit.

Role B: Retreat planner: decide which compromise to propose to your director, without claiming their approval.

Possible opening: We can keep the room category consistent from Wednesday, or accommodate Tuesday arrival with two categories.

Success checks

- Compare both allocations accurately.
- State what requires the director's approval.
- Avoid promising future room availability.

Add a complication: The planner asks you to promise that Tuesday inventory will improve tomorrow.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Revenue Management and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A hotel reports a higher average daily rate but lower occupancy. A manager assumes every revenue measure must have improved.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: ADR, RevPAR, yield management, compression night.

Model response

The average rate and occupancy moved in different directions. We need to look at revenue per available room as well before describing the overall room-revenue performance.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. B - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. Higher room price, lower room revenue - Fictional daily comparison: 100 available rooms on each day; day one sells 80 at an average of 100 units, day two sells 60 at 120 units. Figures exclude other revenue.
2. A compression night is not every night - Separate fictional case: the hotel has high demand on Saturday during a convention, but Friday and Sunday bookings remain lower.

3. Room revenue is not total event revenue - Separate fictional case: a conference booking includes 4,000 units of room revenue and 2,000 of banquet revenue; a trainee puts 6,000 into the hotel's room-revenue measure.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An average hides two room types

A fictional report shows a higher ADR this week, but more suites were sold and standard-room prices were unchanged. No profit data are supplied. Explain the possible booking-mix effect to a sales colleague.

Role A: Revenue analyst: distinguish a higher average selling rate from an increase in every room's price.

Role B: Sales coordinator: paraphrase the distinction and ask what comparison would clarify it.

Possible opening: The average rate rose, but that does not mean the standard-room price increased.

Success checks

- Explain ADR in familiar words.
- Identify the change in room mix.
- Avoid inferring profit without cost information.

Add a complication: The coordinator wants to tell the team that every room became more profitable.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

CASE

Housekeeping marks a room cleaned, but maintenance has an open repair request. Reception asks whether it can be assigned.

Teach this move

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

Vocabulary to check: room status, out of order, turnover, preventive maintenance.

Model response

Cleaning is complete, but the maintenance request is still open. Please confirm the room's approved status with the responsible team before telling reception that it is available.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Second-round challenge

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Language-check answers

1. B - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check. It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.
2. A - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct? This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

05 • Conversations

1. Cleaned is not released - Fictional shift handoff: room 214 is cleaned, but its maintenance repair request remains open and its assignment status has not been cleared.

2. An out-of-order room carries into tomorrow - Separate fictional case: room 509 is out of order pending a replacement part; the supplier has not confirmed delivery. An incoming maintenance coordinator takes over supplier follow-up.

3. A preventive visit clashes with a group arrival - Separate fictional case: preventive maintenance is booked for room 318 tomorrow morning, and a new group allocation lists the same room; no revised appointment is approved.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | The linen delivery handoff

A fictional hotel has received twelve of twenty requested linen bundles. Eight are outstanding, and the delivery time is unknown. The evening supervisor must take over supplier contact and keep reception informed about turnover capacity.

Role A: Day housekeeping supervisor: hand over received and missing quantities and request explicit acceptance.

Role B: Evening housekeeping supervisor: accept supplier follow-up and ask what cannot yet be promised to reception.

Possible opening: Twelve linen bundles are here; eight remain outstanding, and their arrival time is unconfirmed.

Success checks

- Repeat back the received and outstanding quantities.
- Name the person taking supplier follow-up.
- Do not convert missing delivery information into a room-ready promise.

Add a complication: Reception asks whether all remaining rooms will be ready in one hour.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

An event schedule lists "sound check" without a time, room, or responsible contact. The venue and organizer assume the other will arrange it.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: BEO, run of show, attrition, AV requirement.

Model response

Could we confirm the sound-check time, location, and contact person? I'll add those details to the run of show so the venue and organizer share the same plan.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. A - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. What does sound check include? - Fictional banquet planning call: the run of show lists sound check without a room, time, or owner; the organizer knows the presenter needs a wireless microphone.
2. Doors open for whom? - Separate fictional event case: a schedule says doors open at 17:00; suppliers need access, and attendees arrive at 18:00. The meaning of the 17:00 entry is unclear.
3. A guarantee is not an attendance forecast - Separate fictional planning case: a draft BEO lists 90 expected attendees and a separate guaranteed count of 80; the organizer asks what number catering should prepare

against.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Which screen needs the live feed?

A fictional event's AV requirement says live feed. A lobby screen and a stage screen are available, but the requested destination and content are unspecified. The producer and AV coordinator must clarify these before requesting a test.

Role A: AV coordinator: ask focused questions about the screen and intended content.

Role B: Event producer: confirm the lobby screen is intended, but acknowledge that the camera view has not been selected.

Possible opening: When the run of show says live feed, which screen should receive it?

Success checks

- Identify the lobby as the confirmed destination.
- Keep the camera view and testing status open.
- Agree who will obtain the remaining content decision.

Add a complication: The producer asks you to mark the AV requirement complete before the camera view is agreed.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

Heavy weather may affect an excursion. The operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed. Guests ask if the original itinerary is certain.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: itinerary, force majeure, waiver, local operator.

Model response

The operator is reviewing the conditions, so the itinerary is not yet confirmed. I'll share the next official update and explain any approved alternatives when they are available.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 • Conversations

1. Weather concern without a departure decision - Fictional excursion coordination: heavy weather may affect a trip; the local operator has not confirmed whether it will proceed.
2. A photograph is not a trail assessment - Separate fictional tour case: a guide receives an old photograph of a wet trail; no current route assessment has been provided by the local operator.

3. Cancellation does not settle the contract question - Separate fictional case: a local operator has confirmed cancellation of a harbor tour due to weather; the hotel's coordinator has not reviewed the booking's refund terms.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A museum stop may be unavailable

A fictional tour includes a museum. Its public page mentions building work but gives no closure dates, and the local operator has not verified access for the booked day. Discuss what can be said to the group.

Role A: Tour planner: explain the evidence and ask the operator to verify the booked visit.

Role B: Hotel concierge: challenge a proposed announcement that the museum stop is canceled.

Possible opening: The museum mentions building work, but we haven't established whether it affects our booked visit.

Success checks

- Distinguish the published notice from a verified closure.
- Avoid guaranteeing or canceling the visit without confirmation.
- Agree who will seek the operator's update.

Add a complication: A traveler asks whether the unchanged itinerary on their voucher proves access is guaranteed.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A guest declines an offered service. A colleague assumes the reason is the guest's nationality.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: service standard, cultural expectation, guest profile, recovery gesture.

Model response

Let's ask about the guest's preference rather than assume the reason. Would you prefer a different arrangement, or would you like us to explain the available options?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. B - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. Ask before interpreting a declined service - Fictional staff coaching: a guest declines luggage assistance; a porter attributes the choice to nationality, although the guest gave no reason.
2. A recovery gesture needs a preference check - Separate fictional case: a hotel may offer flowers or a fruit basket as an approved recovery gesture; neither has been selected for a corporate traveler.
3. Formal or first-name introductions - Separate fictional case: an event host asks a hotel team how to address an international delegation; delegates have not provided individual preferences.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | How should reception contact the organizer?

A fictional organizer is in meetings between 10:00 and 12:00. Reception can use a phone call or a written message for routine room updates. Their preferred channel is unknown. Agree a communication preference by speaking before the meetings.

Role A: Reception supervisor: ask which available channel the organizer prefers for routine updates.

Role B: Event organizer: choose written messages during the meetings and phone calls afterward.

Possible opening: Which contact method would work best for routine room updates while you're in meetings?

Success checks

- Ask the individual rather than infer a group preference.
- Repeat the two time-dependent channel choices accurately.
- Limit the agreement to routine updates rather than inventing emergency procedures.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests inferring the preference from the organizer's age instead of asking.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-06. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Hospitality and Tourism English

Professional audience: hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Original fictional case: A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Language workshop: Repair a misunderstanding

Communication goal: Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Language guidance: Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): My earlier message did not make ... clear. / I'm sorry for The correct information is / Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Vocabulary: check-in: The process of registering an arrival; also a short meeting to review progress. / room inventory: The rooms available for sale or assignment under the property's current status definitions. / upgrade: A move to a higher service category, room type, or product capability. / service recovery: Actions taken to address a service failure and restore the customer's experience.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.
2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.
3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.
4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.
5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Hospitality and Tourism English

Professional audience: hotel managers, front-desk teams, guest-relations staff, event coordinators, restaurant managers, tour operators, revenue managers, and destination-service professionals

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Original fictional case: A guest arrives before the room is ready after receiving an unclear confirmation message. The desk has a luggage-storage option but no verified room-ready time.

Language workshop: Repair a misunderstanding

Communication goal: Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Language guidance: Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): My earlier message did not make ... clear. / I'm sorry for The correct information is / Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Vocabulary: check-in: The process of registering an arrival; also a short meeting to review progress. / room inventory: The rooms available for sale or assignment under the property's current status definitions. / upgrade: A move to a higher service category, room type, or product capability. / service recovery: Actions taken to address a service failure and restore the customer's experience.

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Optional second-round challenge: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: I'm sorry the message was unclear. Your room is not ready yet. We can store your luggage while I check the status, and I'll give you an update as soon as I have a confirmed time.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.
2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.
3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.
4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.
5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level